

2.1 Introduction To MS Word 2003

Installing and configuring Microsoft Office 2003 is only the beginning of our objective. However, you cannot deny the fact that having MS Office practically means having Word and Excel installed on your computer. In addition, as everybody already knows, Word is the one of the most-used word processing application on any desktop around the world.

There have been many versions of Microsoft Word, starting from a DOS-based text editor. Moreover, with each new revision there have been changes, for the better. In this chapter, we will look at all these new features and more, which will help you get the most out of your favourite word processor.

2.1.1 New Features In Word 2003

- m **Good Looks:** Microsoft Word 2003 is designed to fit in snugly with the Windows XP environment. The Task Panes feature from the previous version of Office is still available, which lets you access documents easily without having to search for them through your computer. Task bars, panes, menus and menu buttons have more definition and colour to completely meld with the Windows XP look and feel.
- m **Task Pane addition:** Another addition to the task panes is the Research Task pane. For using this particular feature, you have to be connected to the Internet. Consider this scenario: you're writing a paper and are stuck on a particular part where you do not have the information. Using the research task pane, you can specify the keywords or the phrase in the task pane, and Word searches for the same on Web sites and online databases you specified as resources. This is a very handy feature, which lets you write your paper and research at the same time.
- m **Improving your reading experience:** Microsoft Word 2003 now includes a new view called the Reading Layout view that lets you view a big multi-page document in the same window. When you are using this view, the standard toolbars are hidden and